

Daniel M. Thompson

Department of Political Science
4289 Bunche Hall
Los Angeles, CA 90095

✉ dthompson at polisci.ucla.edu
📞 danmthompson.com

ACADEMIC POSITIONS

University of California, Los Angeles

Associate Professor, Political Science

2026-Present

Assistant Professor, Political Science

2020-2026

EDUCATION

Stanford University

2016-2020

Ph.D. Political Science

University of California, Berkeley

2012-2014

Master of Public Policy

Berklee College of Music

2007-2010

Bachelor of Music

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Political economy, local politics, elections, public policy, econometrics, data science.

PUBLISHED ARTICLES

Carreri, Maria, Julia Payson, and Daniel M. Thompson. Forthcoming. When Progressives Took Power: The Limited Economic Effects of Municipal Reform in US Cities. *Journal of Historical Political Economy*.

Ferrer, Joshua and Daniel M. Thompson. Forthcoming. Does Leader Turnover Degrade Local Government Performance? Evidence from Local Election Officials. *American Journal of Political Science*.

Wu, Jennifer, Chenoa Yorgason, Hanna Folsz, Sandy Handan-Nader, Andy Myers, Toby Nowacki, Daniel M. Thompson, Jesse Yoder, and Andrew B. Hall. 2024. Are Dead People Voting By Mail? Evidence From Washington State Administrative Records. *Election Law Journal*.

Lal, Apoorva and Daniel M. Thompson. 2024. Did Private Election Administration Funding Advantage Democrats in 2020? *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences* 117(25):1-11.

Ferrer, Joshua, Igor Geyn, and Daniel M. Thompson. 2024. "How Partisan Is Local Election Administration?" *American Political Science Review* 118(2): 956-971.

Thompson, Daniel M. 2022. "Do Citizens Vote Against Incumbents Who Permit Local Immigration? Evidence from the Mariel Boatlift." *Political Science Research and Methods* 11(4): 728-745.

Yoder, Jesse, Sandy Handan-Nader, Andy Myers, Toby Nowacki, Daniel M. Thompson, Jen Wu, Chenoa Yorgason, and Andy Hall. 2021. "How Did Expanding Absentee Voting Affect the 2020 US Election?" *Science Advances*.

- Thompson, Daniel M., Jennifer A. Wu, Jesse Yoder, and Andrew B. Hall. 2020. "Universal Vote-By-Mail Has No Impact on Partisan Turnout or Vote Share." *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences* 117(25): 14052-14056.
- Thompson, Daniel M. 2020. "How Partisan Is Local Law Enforcement? Evidence from Sheriff Cooperation with Immigration Authorities." *American Political Science Review* 114(1): 206-221.
- Hall, Andrew B. and Daniel M. Thompson. 2018. "Who Punishes Extremist Nominees? Candidate Ideology and Turning Out the Base in U.S. Elections." *American Political Science Review* 112(3): 509-524.

WORKING PAPERS

- Partisan Elections and Partisan Voting: Evidence from Partisan Judicial Elections (joint with Mason Reece).
- Fortunate Sons: Elite Political Selection in American History (joint with Andy Hall, James Feigenbaum, and Jesse Yoder).

INVITED PRESENTATIONS

- Yale University CSAP Summer Conference (Poster), New Haven, CT, June 2019
- MIT Congress and History Conference, Cambridge, MA, June 2019
- Endogenous Rules Workshop, Claremont Grad University, Feb 2020
- Goldman School of Public Policy, UC Berkeley, Nov 2021
- Dept of Political Science, UC Irvine, March 2022
- Class and Inequality Conference, Claremont Grad University, April 2022
- Political Institutions and Political Economy Workshop, USC, Sept 2022
- Harris School of Public Policy, U Chicago, Oct 2022
- Dept of Political Science, UCLA, May 2023
- Dept of Political Science, Dartmouth, Sept 2023
- Dept of Political Science, UC Davis, Feb 2024
- Center for the Study of Democratic Politics, Princeton, Sept 2024
- California Center for Population Research, UCLA, Oct 2024
- Harris Political Economy Conference, Stanford GSB, Feb 2025
- American Politics Workshop, UC Berkeley, Feb 2026
- Political Economy and Public Law Conference, Texas A&M Law, June 2026

PROFESSIONAL CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

- American Political Science Association Annual Meeting, 2017, 2018, 2019, 2020, 2021, 2022, 2024, 2026
- Election Science Reform and Administration Conference, 2021, 2023, 2024

Justice and Injustice Mini-Conference, 2020, 2025

Local Political Economy Pre-Conference, 2019

Midwest Political Science Association Annual Meeting, 2017, 2018, 2019, 2022

Society of Political Methodology Annual Meeting, 2023, 2024, 2025

Southern Political Science Association Annual Meeting, 2017, 2022

GRANTS AND AWARDS

Computational Social Science Fellowship, IRiSS, Stanford, 2017-2018

Grant, Center on Philanthropy and Civil Society, Stanford, Winter 2018

Society of Hellman Fellows, UCLA, 2022-2023

COR Faculty Grants Program, UCLA, 2023-2024

Faculty Career Development Award, UCLA, 2023-2024

Workforce Grant Program, Bipartisan Policy Center, 2024-2025

TEACHING

University of California, Los Angeles:

Intro to American Politics, Fall 2021, Fall 2022, Fall 2023, Spring 2026 (undergrad lecture)

Local Politics and Policy, Spring 2021, Spring 2022 (undergrad lecture)

Democratic Elections, Spring 2021, Fall 2021, Fall 2022, Fall 2023, Spring 2026 (grad seminar)

Local Politics and Policy, Spring 2022 (grad seminar)

Intro to American Politics: Political Behavior, Fall 2020 (grad seminar)

Intro to American Politics: Institutions, Winter 2021 (grad seminar)

Stanford University, TA:

Politics and Public Policy, Fall 2018 (undergraduate lecture).

Formal Theory I: An Introduction to Game Theory, Winter 2018 (graduate sequence).

Data Science for Politics, Fall 2017 (undergraduate methods sequence).

University of California, Berkeley, GSI:

Quantitative Methods, Fall 2013, Spring 2014 (masters methods sequence).

Intro to Probability and Stats, Fall 2012, Spring 2013, Summer 2013 (undergraduate lecture).

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Reviewer: *American Journal of Political Science*, *American Political Science Review*, Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management conference abstracts, *The Economic Journal*, *Election Law Journal*, *Electoral Studies*, *Journal of Politics*, *Journal of Public Economics*, *Journal of East Asian Studies*, *Political Analysis*, *Legislative Studies Quarterly*, *Public Opinion Quarterly*,

Quarterly Journal of Political Science, Review of Economics and Statistics, State and Local Government Review, State Politics and Policy Quarterly

Discussant: American Political Science Association (2021, 2022, 2024), Local Political Economy Conference (2023), Midwest Political Science Association (2019, 2022), The Political Economy of the Gilded Age & Progressive Era (2023), SoCal Political Economy Conference (2022, 2023), Society for Political Methodology (2023, 2025), Virtual Political Economy Conference at Norwegian Business School (2021)